

01

CONTEMPORARY SCHOLARLY ANCHOR — [SUPPORTING]**CONTEXT + EXACT CORE**

Contemporary scholarly anchor — [SUPPORTING]: □□ Inference: This strengthens the conceptual question whether supernatural belief is necessary for religion, but it does not displace the syllabus's primary evidence: Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā and Sāṃkhya.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: □ **Fact: Recent 2025–2026 scholarship and reviews continue to discuss religious naturalism as an attempt to retain awe, value, ritual and community within a naturalistic worldview.**

02

VISUAL GATEWAY — DEFINE BEFORE JUDGING**CONTEXT + EXACT CORE**

Visual gateway — define before judging: Master verdict: A personal creator is not necessary for religion, but some disciplined orientation to ultimacy, transformation, community and soteriology is needed to prevent the category from becoming empty.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Religion is a disciplined orientation to an ultimate or sacred order through doctrine, practice, community and transformation; belief in a personal creator is not a necessary condition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Agnosticism suspends judgement about God's existence or knowability; unlike atheism, it withholds assent rather than asserting denial.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Master verdict: A personal creator is not necessary for religion, but some disciplined orientation to ultimacy, transformation, community and soteriology is needed to prevent the category from becoming empty.

ANSWER LINE: **Buddhism is a complete non-creator religion because dependent origination explains suffering, the path disciplines life, the Saṅgha (Buddhist monastic and practitioner community) sustains practice and nirvāṇa (liberation from suffering) supplies the final goal.**